Is it Django or django?

Paths into Django open source contribution

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So. Which is it?

Django or django

Answer: It depends!

Commonly used terms ¶

Here are some style guidelines on commonly used terms throughout the documentation:

- **Django** – when referring to the framework, capitalize Django. It is lowercase only in Python code and in the djangoproject.com logo.




```
    """
    # This backend was renamed in Django 1.9.
    if backend_name == "django.db.backends.postgres
```

```
            request, get_resolver(get_urlconf()), 400, exc
        )
    # The logger is set to django.security, which specifically captures
    # SuspiciousOperation events, unlike the default django.request logger.
    security_logger = logging.getLogger(f"django.security.{exc.__class__.__name__}")
    log_response(
        str(exc),
        exception=exc,
```

Paths into Django open source contribution

01

Understand the processes

02

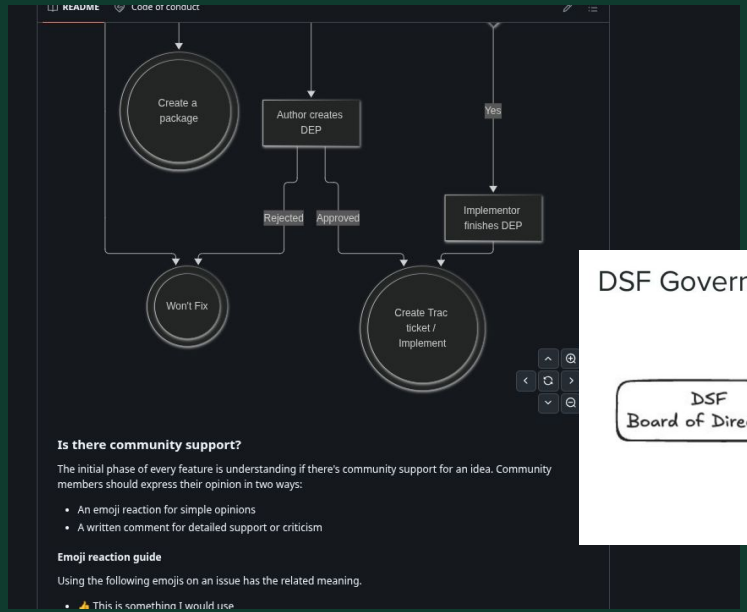
Join a Django sprint

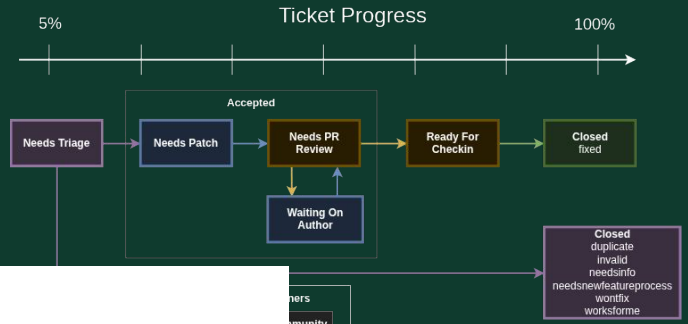
03

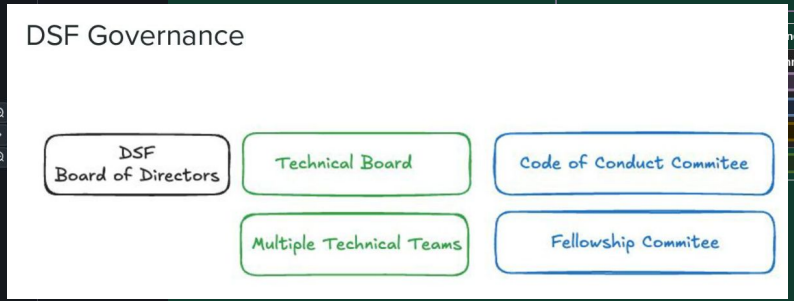
Find a mentor in the community

01 · Understand the structures

For me, that meant understanding the Who, What, and How in changes to Django







Images: governance diagram (S. Abderemane), slide 9; contribution guide; new feature process.

Who?

DSF

The nonprofit foundation that stewards Django

Board of Directors

Elected board that runs the Foundation

Steering Council

Oversees technical leadership

Fellows

Full-time, funded contributors

Working Groups

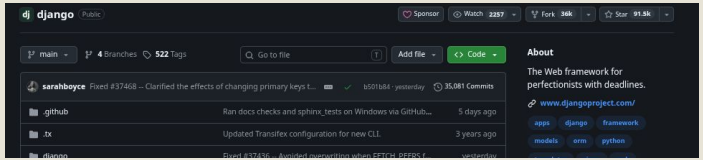
Drive specific community efforts

And more…

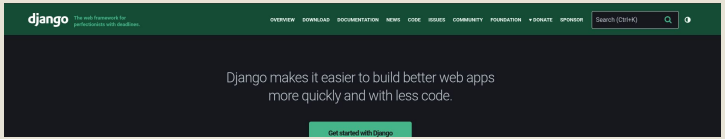
e.g. DSF Members, code of conduct…

What?

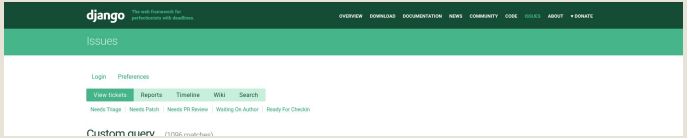
Framework



code.djangoproject.com



Ticket Tracker



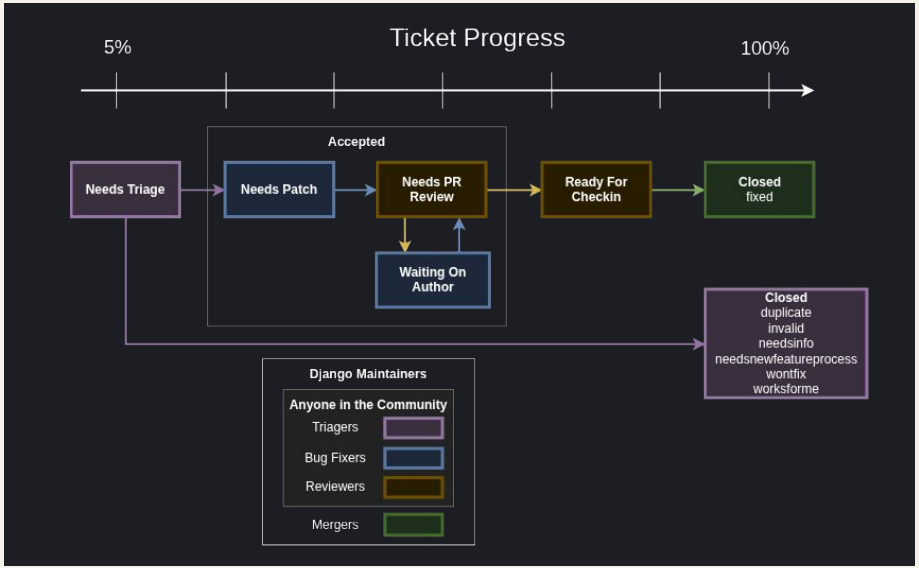
And so on…

E.g. django-asv, django-docker-box, wider Django ecosystem

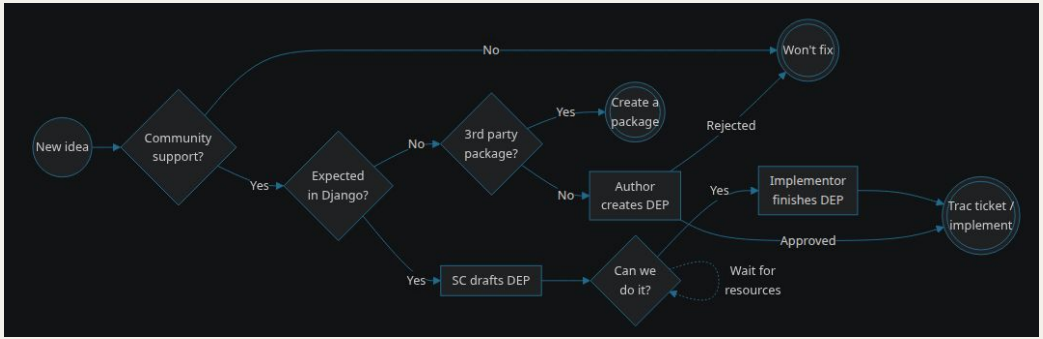
What?

New feature	**Bug**	**Cleanup / optimisation**
Documentation	**Security issue**	**Translation**

How?



Ticket Triage workflow



New feature process

Unofficial end-to-end process diagram ↗

[Tip: Share Your Working]

Thanks to the Python Leadership Group for reviewing a first draft version of this diagram



02 · Join a Sprint



For me, that was Django on the Med - which felt like a mixture between the sprints of a DjangoCon Europe + group holiday











What is a sprint?

A sprint is a get-together where people work on the same (open source) project at the same time

When & where

Namely at conferences, meetups, and online

Who comes

Typically open to everyone working on said project

What you do

E.g. fix bugs, write docs, review tickets, implement features

Django on the Med: The Sprints

How it ran

- Experienced contributors and newcomers together
- Every day, 08:30–13:30
- Progress sharing

Why it helps

- Help is right there if you get stuck
- Dedicated, distraction-free focus
- Accountability
- Mentorship



Django on the Med: The Social Side

Events

- Beach trip
- Cycle trip
- group meals
- Many more!

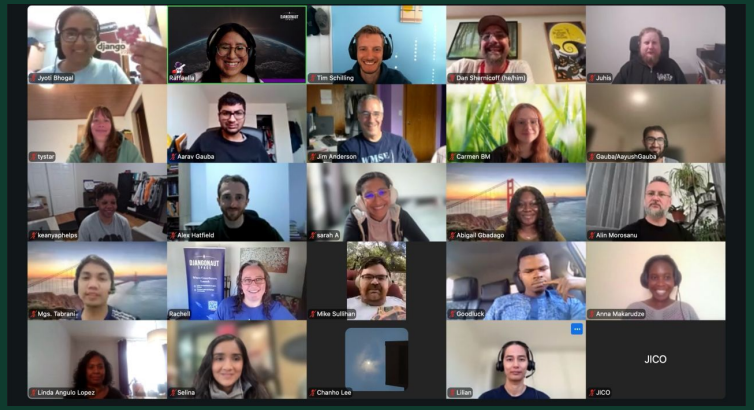
Why it helps

- Conversations from sprints continue
- Strengthening connections
- Fun and making new friends!!



03 · Find a Django Community Mentor

For me, that's Djangonaut Space





What is Djangonaut Space?

An eight-week group mentoring programme

Teams of three Djangonauts, each with two mentors:

- Navigator - technical mentor
- Captain - community mentor

Extensive embedding into the Django ecosystem

Contribute to: Django, Django CMS, Wagtail, Django Packages

Vision: mentees go on to take on Django leadership roles - e.g. maintainers, board members

djangonaut.space

Where I am right now

Team

Team Aquila

Project: Django CMS

Navigator: Fabian Braun, Django CMS Fellow

Progress so far

Updated documentation in a Django CMS update tool

Diagnosing migration bug in blogging app

Currently

Extending the DRF API to include page extension data

Summary

01

Understand the structure

02

Participate in a Django sprint

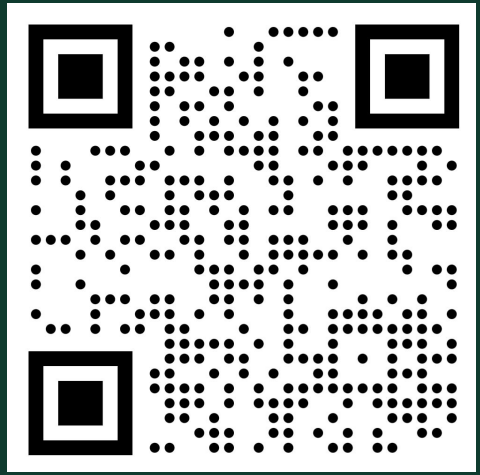
03

Find a mentor in the Django community

Alex Hatfield

channels

website	alexhatfield.com
email	alex.hatfield.tech@gmail.com
consulting	lxfield.dev
linkedin	linkedin.com/in/alex-hatfield-tech
github	github.com/HatfieldAlex
bluesky	@alex-hatfield-tech.bsky.social
mastodon	@alex_hatfield_tech@fosstodon.org



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